

Ashnikko Covers Gwen Stefani Hit on Triple J's Like A Version

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American singer Ashnikko has made her debut on triple j's **Like A Version**, covering Gwen Stefani's 2004 song "What You Waiting For?"

She performed in the triple j studio during her Australian tour with a full backing band that included a harpist. The **electropop**-leaning **cover** stayed close to Stefani's original while adding Ashnikko's own style. She also performed her own song "Sticky Fingers."

Ashnikko called "What You Waiting For?" the song of her childhood and the track that inspired her to make music. She credited Stefani's solo album Love. Angel. Music. Baby. as an early influence. In an interview with hosts Abby Butler and Tyrone Pynor, she also talked about bird watching and how important dance moves are to her shows.

Stefani's song was the lead single from that 2004 album and reached No. 47 on the **Billboard Hot 100**. The album peaked at No. 7 on the Billboard 200 and included hits such as "Hollaback Girl" and "Rich Girl." Stefani is also known as the frontwoman of No Doubt and has won four Grammy Awards.

Ashnikko broke through in 2019 with "Stupid," a song that spread widely on TikTok, reached No. 90 on the Hot 100, and later earned a platinum certification. Her 2023 debut album Weedkiller charted on the Billboard 200. **Like A Version** is a long-running Australian radio segment known for memorable live **covers**.

The performance adds another chapter to Ashnikko's mix of **hyperpop**, rap, and alternative sounds.

Word Treasure

Like A Version -- An Australian radio segment known for live cover performances.

electropop -- A pop music style that relies heavily on electronic sounds.

cover -- A new performance of a song originally made famous by someone else.

Billboard Hot 100 -- A major U.S. chart that ranks popular songs.

hyperpop -- A bold, electronic-heavy music style Ashnikko often blends with other sounds.

Background you need

Radio live sessions often invite artists to perform one famous cover and one of their own songs.

A cover lets a musician honor an influence while showing a personal style.

Chart rankings track how widely songs are played and purchased over time.

Tour stops sometimes include special broadcast performances for local audiences.

Break it down

LEAD: Ashnikko debuts on triple j Like A Version

KEY EVENT: Covers Stefani's What You Waiting For? on Australian tour

+ - ALSO PLAYS: Sticky Fingers

+ - BAND: Full group including a harpist

CONTEXT: Stefani 2004 solo hit; Ashnikko's 2019 breakthrough

OPEN QUESTION: How fans will compare the cover with the original

Why it matters

Hearing how a modern artist remakes a childhood favorite shows how music influences travel across years. Live radio covers also introduce kids to performance as creative homage, not just copying.

Test what you remember

1. Which Gwen Stefani song did Ashnikko cover?
 - ☐ (A) What You Waiting For?
 - ☐ (B) Stupid
 - ☐ (C) Hollaback Girl only
 - ☐ (D) Sticky Fingers
2. What Australian radio segment featured the performance?
 - ☐ (A) Virginia Tech STAR test
 - ☐ (B) NPR Student Podcast Challenge
 - ☐ (C) Sotheby's auction block
 - ☐ (D) Like A Version on triple j
3. Which of her own songs did she also perform?
 - ☐ (A) Love. Angel. Music. Baby.
 - ☐ (B) What You Waiting For?
 - ☐ (C) Sticky Fingers
 - ☐ (D) Weedkiller
4. When did Ashnikko break through with "Stupid"?
 - ☐ (A) 2019
 - ☐ (B) 2004
 - ☐ (C) 2026 only
 - ☐ (D) 1905
5. What instrument is specially mentioned in her backing band?
 - ☐ (A) A tuba only
 - ☐ (B) A kazoo
 - ☐ (C) A harp
 - ☐ (D) A bagpipe
6. What did Ashnikko call Stefani's song?
 - ☐ (A) A science lecture
 - ☐ (B) A bike helmet ad
 - ☐ (C) A weather report
 - ☐ (D) The song of her childhood that inspired her to make music

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: D 3: C 4: A 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Ashnikko: Called the Stefani track her childhood song and the inspiration to pursue music.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):